

## Chapter 165-1

In the middle of the night, Liang Shi was woken up by Zhao Xuning's phone call.

Liang Shi glanced at Xu Qingzhu beside her, who was only frowning slightly, made restless by the ringtone. Liang Shi first muted her phone, then patted Xu Qingzhu's back and tiptoed out of bed to answer the call.

After the call connected, all she could hear was the howling sound of wind.

Liang Shi asked her, "Where are you?"

After a long while, Zhao Xuning finally said, "Look down from upstairs."

Liang Shi immediately walked to the window and looked down. On the Yujiang Bridge, there was a white figure—actually just a small white dot.

Looking from the tenth floor, she could barely see more than a speck of light.

But inexplicably, Liang Shi just knew it was Zhao Xuning.

All her drowsiness vanished at once. She hurriedly threw on a coat and headed out. "What are you doing?"

There was no response from Zhao Xuning's end.

The sounds of traffic and wind burrowed into Liang Shi's ears.

Zhao Xuning said, "Don't come out."

Liang Shi frowned. "Are you drunk?"

She was already stepping into the elevator as she spoke.

"I'm fine," Zhao Xuning said.

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, wanting to say that she really didn't sound fine at all.

Even though Zhao Xuning told her not to come down, Liang Shi still went downstairs out of humanitarian concern.

In the end, she found Zhao Xuning slumped on the ground by the Yujiang Bridge.

As luck would have it, snow was falling that day.

Snowflakes fluttered down, quickly blanketing the ground in a layer of white.

Zhao Xuning was not spared either—the white snow had turned her hair a pale color, making her look like a corpse.

Liang Shi was startled when she saw her and immediately ran over to help her up. The smell of alcohol was all over her.

Even with such strong wind, the smell of cigarettes and alcohol on her was still unmistakable.

The glasses she had been wearing when she went out were nowhere to be found. Zhao Xuning lay on the ground like a puddle of mud, without any will to live.

"Get up," Liang Shi said.

Zhao Xuning didn't respond. She rolled over while lying on the ground, her white coat already stained with dirt.

This was the first time Liang Shi had ever seen Zhao Xuning so dejected, so disheveled.

"Zhao Xuning." Liang Shi squatted down and pushed her again. "What on earth happened?"

Zhao Xuning sniffled and sat up, leaning against a bridge pillar. Suddenly she murmured, "A-Hui?"

Tender and gentle.

But she had called out to the wrong person, and hearing it gave Liang Shi goosebumps all over.

Liang Shi pushed her again. Zhao Xuning was too drunk to sit steadily; one push from Liang Shi and she nearly toppled over, so Liang Shi had to reach out and push her back upright.

Pushing and propping—it was like playing with a roly-poly toy.

Liang Shi sighed helplessly. "Come on, I'll take you home."

Zhao Xuning was probably cold. She curled up her legs, hugged her knees, and rested her head on them, her hair falling all around her.

If those gossipy little nurses at the hospital saw this, their jaws would surely drop.

"I don't have a home anymore." Zhao Xuning said, "Where would I even have a home?"

Zhao Xuning's voice was choked with sobs.

Liang Shi pulled at her. "I'll take you to my place."

"I want my home," Zhao Xuning said.

A drunk Zhao Xuning was especially stubborn and wouldn't listen to reason.

Liang Shi was only wearing pajamas with a coat casually thrown over them—not warm at all.

She was shivering from the cold, yet Zhao Xuning was still throwing a drunken tantrum.

Though calling it a drunken tantrum wasn't quite right either. She was simply immersed in her own world, acting like a madwoman, a fool, someone lost in delusion.

She didn't ask Liang Shi to do anything.

It was only after a long while that she asked, seemingly lucid, "Liang Shi, can I win Shen Hui back?"

Liang Shi froze.

Before she could answer, the sound of high heels clicking against the ground came from behind her—*click-clack, click-clack*.

Against the backdrop of traffic noise, it sounded particularly eerie.

Liang Shi turned around and found that it was Shen Hui.

Shen Hui's eyes were red, as if she had been crying hard.

As she passed by, she nodded in greeting to Liang Shi, then walked straight toward Zhao Xuning.

Shen Hui didn't say anything. She just slowly squatted down in front of Zhao Xuning. "Let's go."

Brief and to the point.

"A-Hui?" Zhao Xuning called out softly, like a lover's murmur.

Shen Hui pinched her neck, and the pain made Zhao Xuning frown. "You hit me again."

The words sounded like a complaint, as if the two of them were on good terms.

But Shen Hui's face remained cold. "Get up."

Zhao Xuning shook her head. "I can't get up anymore."

Shen Hui stood up and looked down at her from above. "Then what were you doing tonight? Going to the shop and saying those things, doing those things—what are you trying to do?"

Zhao Xuning tilted her head up, and tears slid down her cheeks, melting the snowflakes that had fallen on her face. Water traced a path down her cheeks as she murmured, "A-Hui."

"Don't call me that." Shen Hui's voice was choked. "Zhao Xuning, I'm asking you—what do you want to do? Answer me."

The howling wind swirled the snowflakes into a dance.

The streetlamps on the Yujiang Bridge cast a dim yellow glow, wrapping the snowflakes in that same hazy light before they scattered gently upon the world.